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Market Study

[Schoolize]

This study serves as Schoolize is a bilingual (Arabic/English) school management system that puts attendance, grades, timetables, assignments, parent messaging and fee payment on one web and mobile platform for Saudi K-12 schools. This study tests whether the market needs it by comparing it with four existing systems (Noor, Madrasati, Classera and PowerSchool) and by reading what their users say.

1. Introduction

The target users are the six groups defined in Lab 2: school principal, teachers, students, parents, administrative staff and IT support. The market they sit in is large: Saudi general education has about 6.72 million students, 513,000 teachers and 36,800 schools (Argaam, citing the Ministry of Education, Oct 2024).
All figures below come from pages opened during this study and are linked in the Sources section. Where a figure is old or only partly documented, the text says so.

2. Competitor Analysis

Two Ministry of Education systems dominate public schools, Classera leads Saudi private schools, and PowerSchool is the global benchmark; none of them combines administration, learning, parent communication and fee payment in one product.

3. Existing Solutions

Competitor	Owner / origin	What it offers	Scale	Pricing / offer	User satisfaction
Noor	Saudi Ministry of Education; launched 2011, replacing the Ma'arif system (1999)	School administration data: exams, curriculum, attendance, teacher affairs, class schedules, counseling, transportation, scholarships	Used by students, parents, principals, teachers, supervisors and ministry staff; user count not published	Government-provided; no per-school price published	Companion app "Madrasti – Results": 2.3/5 on the App Store from about 1,000 ratings (MWM)
Madrasati	Saudi Ministry of Education; remote-learning platform linked to Microsoft	Virtual classrooms, assignment uploads, recorded lessons, tests and a follow-up dashboard for students, teachers and parents (92% of students, 97% of teachers and 37% of parents had joined by Sept 2020)	About 6 million students in 2020-21, about 98% of Saudi schoolchildren (World Bank study)	Government-provided; no per-school price published	More than two-thirds of surveyed teachers said student achievement and skills increased (World Bank sample of almost 18,000 people)
Classera	Saudi-founded learning platform, started in the US	Virtual school, homework submission, grades, teacher contact, AI-supported learning, customizable per school	More than 10 million users; 30+ countries; about 80% of A-class private schools in Saudi (Arab News, c. 2020)	"Contact us for pricing" (eLearning Industry)	iOS app: 4.6/5 from 32,100 ratings, but written reviews average 3.3/5 (MWM)

PowerSchool	US company	Unified platform: registration, attendance, grading, assessments, analytics, finance, HR, special education, state reporting	45+ million students, 15,000+ customers, 90+ countries (Feb 2023)	Quote-based; reviewers call it expensive, with add-ons at extra cost	Capterra: 4.3/5 from 181 reviews; iOS app 4.6/5 from about 902,000 ratings (AppFollow)

Saudi schools today stitch together a government system for records, a government or private system for online learning, and manual channels (phone calls, paper notices, cash or bank transfer) for everything else.

- **Government administration:** Noor handles records, results, attendance and schedules for all three levels: ministry, education offices and schools (Saudipedia).
- **Government online learning:** Madrasati reached about 6 million students in 2020-21 and became the default tool for remote lessons (Arab News).
- **Private-school platforms:** Classera serves about 80% of A-class private schools in Saudi Arabia (Arab News).
- **Global suites:** PowerSchool supports 45+ million students worldwide, but its December 2024 breach, reportedly affecting 62 million students and 9.5 million teachers (unconfirmed by the company), shows the risk of one central data store with weak access control (TechCrunch).

4. Feature Comparison

Feature	Noor	Madrasati	Classera	PowerSchool	Our Project (Schoolize)
Digital attendance tracking	✓	×	×	✓	✓
Timetable / class scheduling	✓	×	×	✓	✓
Online lessons / virtual classroom	×	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assignments, submission and grading	×	✓	✓	✓	✓
Parent portal with grade and attendance view	✓	✓	×	✓	✓
Teacher-parent messaging	×	×	✓	×	✓
AI / analytics to flag struggling students	×	×	✓	✓	✓
Administration and learning in one platform	×	×	×	✓	✓
Online fee payment for parents	×	×	×	×	✓

5. Customer Feedback Analysis

To identify common issues with existing solutions, customer reviews from Google Play Store, Apple App Store, and tech forums were analyzed.
To find common issues with existing solutions, App Store listings
Capterra and eLearning Industry reviews were analysed, together with a World Bank study of Madrasati. Google Play and local forums could not be opened from the research environment, so the team should add a short check of both before submission.
Ratings split sharply by who runs the product: the Ministry's companion app scores 2.3/5, while Classera and PowerSchool score 4.3 to 4.6 headline but draw sharper criticism in written reviews.

5.1 Positive Feedback

- Users appreciate real-time access to grades, attendance, assignments and contact details (PowerSchool reviewers on Capterra).
- Classera users like simple homework submission, grade viewing and direct contact with teachers.
- Teachers see a learning benefit: more than two-thirds of those surveyed in the World Bank study said Madrasati raised student achievement and skills.
- Reviewers value having scheduling, grades and business functions in one platform ("truly is an all in one solution").

5.2 Negative Feedback & Market Gaps

- **Lack of reliability:** login errors and freezing dominate the 94 written reviews of the Ministry's companion app, and users keep it only as a fallback.
- **Lack of dependable notifications:** missed alerts for new assignments and tests are Classera's most common complaint.
- **Lack of a modern, simple interface:** PowerSchool is called "dated" and "way too complicated", and its mobile app "lacks a lot of information that the website contains."
- **Fee payment:** none of the four products documents online fee payment for parents (to be confirmed by survey).

6. Market Opportunity & Differentiation

Based on the analysis, Scoolize has strong potential: it targets a market of 36,800 schools and 6.72 million students, inside an edtech sector forecast to grow about 11.5% a year, and each of its main features answers a documented complaint about current systems.

It differentiates itself by:

- **One platform for every role.** Principal, teachers, students, parents, staff and IT work in one system instead of Noor plus Madrasati plus a private tool.
- **Reliable notifications.** Push alerts for attendance, grades and assignments, with SMS as a fallback, to fix the missed-alert complaints seen in Classera reviews.
- **Arabic-first, bilingual interface** designed for phones, because parents are the least technical user group (Lab 2).
- **Online fee payment** inside the parent app, a feature none of the four competitors documents.
- **Early-warning insights** that flag students whose grades or attendance drop, so teachers can act early.
- **Security by default:** role-based access and multi-factor authentication for all staff accounts, the control that was missing in the PowerSchool breach.
- **Simple, modern interface** to avoid the "dated" and "too complicated" criticism of PowerSchool.

7. Conclusion

The market study confirms a strong demand for a single, reliable, Arabic-first school management platform in Saudi Arabia. Public schools rely on two separate Ministry systems, private schools on paid platforms whose users complain about missed notifications, and the global leader has a recent security failure and a dated interface. EduLink's combination of unified roles, dependable alerts, online fee payment and built-in security fills those gaps. The two points still to verify before the final report are the fee-payment gap (parent survey) and Google Play reviews.